The Invisible Revolution: How Two Brothers Freed India's Infrastructure from Foreign Dependency

While India celebrated software exports and pharmaceutical breakthroughs, Pankaj and Vipin Lidoo were solving a problem most didn't know existed—making India self-reliant in the humble fasteners that literally hold the nation's infrastructure together.

In 1999, India's construction boom faced an absurd vulnerability. Every metro station, power plant, and railway shed being built with modern color-coated sheet technology depended entirely on self-drilling screws imported from Taiwan. Project timelines stretched, costs escalated, and builders waited weeks for components as basic as screws to arrive across the Indian Ocean.

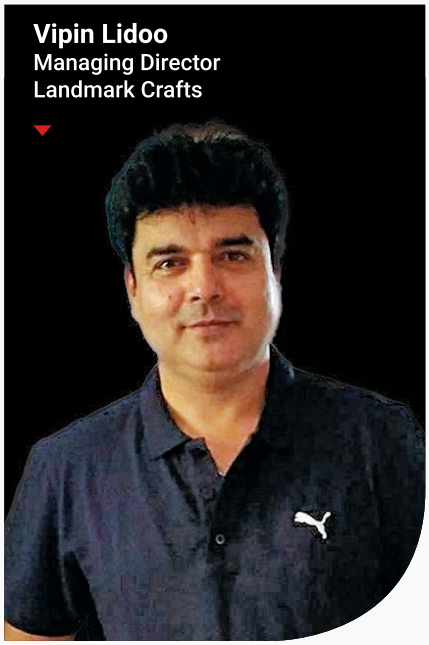
The Lidoo brothers from Ghaziabad saw what others overlooked: India's infrastructure ambitions were hostage to foreign suppliers for something as fundamental as a fastener. Rather than profit from import trading, they chose the harder path, opting for multiple research trips to Taiwan, substantial R&D investments, and complex technology transfer negotiations to establish India's first indigenous manufacturing facility for specialized fasteners.

"We realized that India's infrastructure dreams were literally being held together by imported fasteners," recalls Pankaj Lidoo, Managing Director of Landmark Crafts. "Every construction delay, every cost overrun happened because builders had to wait for specialized screws from abroad."

By the early 2000s, as infrastructure spending accelerated, Landmark's products became the invisible sinews of national development. Delhi Metro's pioneering phases, BHEL installations, and Indian Railways projects relied on fasteners stamped "Made in India" for the first time. The company had achieved manufacturing self-reliance in a critical industrial component while building a profitable enterprise—embodying "Make in India" decades before it became policy.



Pankaj Lidoo
Director
Landmark Crafts



Vipin Lidoo
Managing Director
Landmark Crafts

But the brothers understood India's diversity demanded customization. In Himachal Pradesh's timber-heavy zones, they supplied wood-specific solutions. Along Karnataka's coastline, anti-corrosive variants battled salt air. For metro systems spanning multiple cities, they provided tailored fastening solutions. This geographic and application-based customization became their competitive advantage.

"In every assembled product, there is a fastener holding the structure strong and safe," Pankaj explains. "We provide the strength you may not see, but you can always trust."

Today, Landmark operates ISO 9001:2015 certified facilities in Panchkula, backed by a CRISIL SME-1 rating validating their operational excellence. Their portfolio has expanded beyond self-drilling screws to include aluminium blind rivets and drywall screws, with concrete wall screws in development. A strategic network ensures nationwide accessibility across India's vast geography.

Landmark's journey epitomizes transformation beyond headlines—from import dependence to indigenous capability, from technology buyer to infrastructure enabler. In an era obsessed with unicorn valuations and digital disruption, they represent a different success metric: measured in structural integrity rather than market buzz, in industrial self-reliance rather than venture funding.

Sometimes the smallest components enable the biggest transformations. And sometimes, the most profound revolutions happen one screw at a time—quietly, persistently, holding the nation together.